Exam Case # 4

CANDIDATE'S INSTRUCTIONS

A woman presents with concern at your community clinic pharmacy. Also, assist her with any concerns she has regarding her condition

Time Frame: You have 7 minutes to complete this station.

References: CTMA chapter constipation

On the desk: **Metamucil**, Restolax, Sennakot, Doculax

Solution

- There was no profile on the desk.
- Pharmacist medication history, allergies, medication.
- She is using maternal supplements and iron supplement.
- Identifies that she is pregnant in her 2nd trimester. Experiencing constipation and no bowel movement 3 days.
- Assessed here the severity of constipation, duration of constipation, and number of bowel movements.
- **Step approach**
- **Excluding criteria referrals: GI bleeding, dark stool, family history colon, cancer, unexplained weight loss. Any sudden onset of changes in bowel habit.**
- **Ask her choice of any specific medications. Selected medications are provided on the desk.**
- **Recommended psyllium 3.4 g once daily can take 2 to 3 times daily because it has no systemic absorption and can use in pregnancy. and take with full glass of water. Separate from iron and multivitamin at least 2 to 4 hours.**
- Take with plenty of fluids (at least 250 mL) to prevent esophageal obstruction and/or fecal impaction
- It will constipation in 12 to 72 hours. Rarely can cause side effect of abdominal discomfort.
- **Lifestyle modifications, increased fluid intake, more fiber, vegetables, fruits, walking.**
- **If no improvement in 7 days, refer**
- **Follow up**